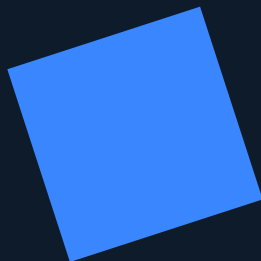


SPIKE RUNNER

OFFICIAL PLAYER GUIDE

A fast reflex-based, gravity-shifting game



JUMP → AVOID → COLLECT → SHIFT → SURVIVE

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About This Guide

Spike Runner, its artwork, and this player guide were produced with the assistance of artificial intelligence as an educational exercise in game design and documentation. Any resemblance between this game's concept, visuals, or naming and any existing commercial product is coincidental and unintentional. This material is not for commercial distribution and is intended solely for learning purposes.

1. Introduction

Spike Runner is a reflex-based arcade game built around jumping, gravity changes, obstacle avoidance, and resource management.

The player controls a blue square that automatically remains attached to either the bottom or top side of the arena.

The game progressively becomes faster, requiring increasingly precise jumps and reactions.

2. Objective

Your main objective is to:

- Avoid red spikes
- Jump over obstacles
- Collect green Strength fuel
- Touch yellow Gravity Feed to invert gravity
- Maintain your Strength
- Survive as long as possible
- Beat your previous score

The game does not have a traditional finish line. Your score continuously increases while you survive.

3. Getting Started

3.01 Starting Spike Runner game

Spike Runner runs entirely inside a single HTML file (Spike Runner.html) and requires no installation. The steps below work on any desktop operating system and any modern browser.

1. Locate the Spike Runner.html file on your computer (for example, in your Downloads folder)
2. Double-click the file. It will normally open automatically in your default web browser
3. If it does not open automatically, right-click the file, choose "Open with," and select a browser such as Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Mozilla Firefox, or Safari
4. Alternatively, open your browser first, then use File → Open File (or press Ctrl+O on Windows/Linux, Cmd+O on Mac) and select Spike Runner.html
5. You can also drag and drop the Spike Runner.html file directly into an open browser window

6. Allow a few seconds for the page to finish loading, then follow the on-screen instructions to begin playing

Operating System	Quick Tip
Windows	Double-click the file in File Explorer, or right-click → Open with → choose your browser.
macOS	Double-click the file in Finder, or right-click (Control-click) → Open With → choose your browser.
Linux	Double-click the file in your file manager, or run <code>xdg-open "Spike Runner.html"</code> from a terminal.

This works identically for Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Safari, Brave, Opera, and most other modern browsers, since Spike Runner uses only standard web technologies.

3.02 After Starting the game

When the game opens, you will see the SPIKE RUNNER Title screen. Read the instructions on screen and you can continue using:

- Enter
- Space
- Mouse click
- Screen tap

You will then reach the Theme Selection screen. You can use mouse click or Enter to proceed further. At Theme selection, use arrow keys / mouse click to select theme and press Enter to confirm.

The game then displays a short loading screen with a random gameplay tip. After loading finishes, gameplay begins.

4. Controls

Desktop Keyboard

Key	Action
Space	Jump
B	Slow the game
N	Speed up the game
P	Pause / Resume
Enter	Confirm / Continue
Left Arrow	Select Black theme
Right Arrow	Select White theme
T	Change theme after Game Over

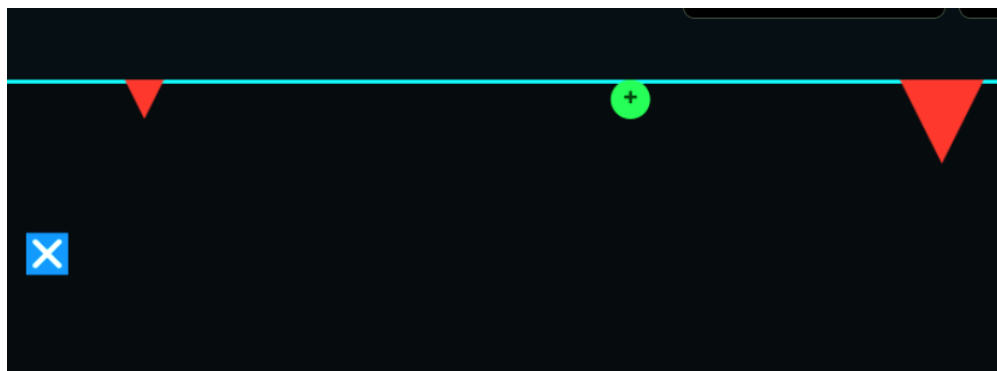
5. Gameplay

The arena has two possible gravity surfaces:

- Normally the square travels along the current gravity surface
- Red spikes appear ahead of the player — you must jump over them
- Eventually, special yellow Gravity Feed can change the direction of gravity



Bottom Gravity — White Theme (player mid-jump over red spikes)



Inverted Gravity — Black Theme (player left with 0 strength but green Strength fuel ahead)

5.01 The Player

The player is represented by a plain **blue square**. The square has physical movement and rotation. During a jump it rotates smoothly, and the rotation depends on the current gravity direction.

Normal Bottom Gravity

The square jumps upward and rotates clockwise. After landing, the square returns to a stable position.

Inverted Top Gravity

When gravity is reversed, the square moves toward the top side. Its rotation direction is reversed so the movement remains visually consistent with the new gravity direction. When it lands on the top surface, it becomes stable again.

5.02 Red Spikes

Red spikes are the primary hazards. They appear randomly throughout gameplay. Spike heights vary — some spikes are short while others are considerably taller. However, spike heights remain within the intended jump capability of the player.

Spike Direction

Actual in-game spikes, shown below for reference:



Bottom gravity — spike
points up



Inverted gravity — spike
points down

Spike heights vary from short to tall, but always remain within jumpable range:



Short spike



Tall spike

Spike Separation

Red spikes are intentionally separated from one another. They should not spawn directly on top of or physically merge with another spike. This keeps individual obstacles readable and makes each jump meaningful.

5.03 Yellow Gravity Feed

The yellow object is a **yellow square**. It is not a normal spike — touching it changes the direction of gravity.



Yellow Gravity Feed

What Happens When You Collect It?

1. Gravity immediately reverses
2. The player transitions toward the opposite side
3. Existing red spikes are cleared
4. A temporary safe period begins
5. Yellow Gravity Feed is prevented from immediately appearing again
6. The square rotates during the transition
7. Gameplay continues on the opposite side

Safe Period

After gravity changes, the player receives a short period of safety. During this period, no red spikes are immediately placed ahead of the player — this prevents the gravity transition from becoming unfair.

5.04 Green Strength Fuel

The green object is a **medium-sized green circle** with a black “+” symbol. It is intentionally larger than a tiny pickup but remains small enough to be a jumpable gameplay object. It is not a spike.



Green Strength Fuel

Collecting Green Fuel

Touching the green circle grants **Strength +1**. The screen briefly flashes light green, providing immediate visual feedback that the pickup was successfully collected.

Strength Limit

The game limits the player's Strength to **3**. Collecting green fuel beyond the maximum does not allow Strength to grow indefinitely.

5.05 Strength System

Strength represents the player's ability to survive collisions. The game starts with **Strength = 3**.

Red Spike Collision

Every red spike collision removes exactly **1 Strength**:



Strength > 0



Hit Red Spike



Strength 0 (X appears)

The collided spike is destroyed.

Damaged State

When Strength reaches zero, the square displays a **white X** drawn directly on the square, clearly indicating that the player is damaged. A collision effect also briefly highlights the square.



Damaged player (0 Strength)

Next Fatal Collision

If the player has zero Strength and collides with another red spike: **GAME OVER**.

5.06 Gravity System

Gravity normally pulls the player toward the bottom surface. Yellow Gravity Feed reverses this.

State	Gravity
Bottom	Downward
Top	Upward



Bottom Gravity



Top Gravity

Gravity Transition

Gravity inversion is designed to feel physical rather than instantaneous teleportation. The square moves toward the new surface while rotating. Once it reaches the surface, it becomes stable.

5.07 Scoring and High Score

The score increases continuously while the player survives: more distance means a higher score. The gameplay HUD displays **High Score** and **Current Score** during gameplay.

Game Over Score

When the player dies, the Game Over screen displays the result of the current run and whether a new high score was achieved.

Restart

Selecting Restart begins a completely new run. The gameplay starts again from Score = 0, Strength = 3, Gravity = Bottom. Restarting does not simply reload the HTML page.

5.08 Game Speed

The game progressively becomes faster. At the beginning, the game runs at Normal Speed. As the score increases, game speed increases, spikes arrive faster, and reaction time decreases — providing increasing difficulty without traditional stages.

Manual Slowdown — Hold B

Temporarily slows gameplay. Useful when:

- A tall spike approaches
- Multiple objects are visible
- Gravity has recently changed
- You need more time to judge a jump

Manual Speed Boost — Hold N

Temporarily speeds up gameplay. Useful for experienced players who want a more challenging run.

5.09 Pause Mode

Press **P** to pause the game. The screen displays **PAUSED**. Press P again to resume. While paused:

- Player physics stop
- Spikes stop moving
- Score stops increasing
- Input cannot accidentally trigger jumps

5.10 Themes

Spike Runner provides two visual themes.

Black Theme (default)

- Dark background
- White interface text
- Blue player
- Red spikes
- Yellow Gravity Feed
- Green Strength fuel

The dark theme provides a classic arcade appearance.

White Theme

The white theme changes the background to a light color while retaining the core gameplay colors — the player remains blue, spikes remain red, fuel remains yellow and green.

Input	Result
Left Arrow	Black theme
Right Arrow	White theme
Enter	Confirm

Themes can also be selected using the mouse or touchscreen.

5.11 Game Over

Game Over occurs when the player has no remaining Strength and receives another damaging red-spike collision.

Available options include **Restart** and **Change Theme**.

Restart

Restarting starts a new game from zero. The player receives Strength = 3, Score = 0, Gravity = Bottom.

Change Theme

Selecting Change Theme returns to the theme selector. You can choose Black or White without refreshing the webpage.

6. Strategy Tips

6.1 Watch the Spike Height

Not every spike has the same height. Tall spikes require earlier and more deliberate jumping. Do not wait until the spike is directly beside the square.

6.2 Learn the Jump Arc

Spend the first few seconds learning how far the square travels during a normal jump. Once you understand the jump arc, obstacle timing becomes much easier.

6.3 Do Not Panic During Gravity Changes

When a yellow square appears:

1. Prepare for the gravity change
2. Touch the yellow Gravity Feed
3. Follow the square's movement toward the new surface
4. Use the safe transition period
5. Prepare for inverted spikes

6.4 Collect Green Fuel Carefully

Green fuel gives +1 Strength and can be extremely valuable when your Strength is low. However, do not take an unnecessary risk simply to collect it.

6.5 Use B Strategically

Holding B slows gameplay. Use it when the screen becomes difficult to read — for example, a tall spike combined with a gravity transition and green fuel can become much easier to manage while slowed down.

6.6 Use N for Challenge

N increases the gameplay speed temporarily. Use it only when you are comfortable with the current obstacle pattern.

6.7 Use Pause

If you need to stop, press P to pause the game rather than leaving the browser tab.

7. Quick Reference

Feature	Action / Result
Jump	Space / Tap / Click
Slow	Hold B
Speed Up	Hold N
Pause	P
Restart	Enter / Space after Game Over
Theme	Left / Right
Confirm Theme	Enter
Change Theme	T after Game Over
Red Spike	-1 Strength
Red Spike Collision	Spike destroyed
Yellow Square	Reverse gravity
Green Circle	+1 Strength
Maximum Strength	3
Starting Strength	3
Zero Strength	White X appears
Fatal Collision	Game Over
Player	Blue square
Red Hazard	Spike
Gravity Feed	Yellow square
Strength Fuel	Green circle

8. Troubleshooting

Q: The game does not respond to keyboard input

A: Click/tap the webpage once and try again. Make sure the browser tab is active.

Q: Mobile tapping does not jump

A: Tap directly on the game canvas. The game is designed to use pointer input for mobile devices.

Q: The game appears paused

A: Press P to resume.

Q: The theme does not change

A: On the theme selection screen: Left Arrow selects Black, Right Arrow selects White, Enter confirms. You can also tap the desired theme.

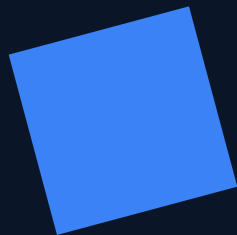
Q: The game ends quickly

A: Remember that Strength decreases by 1 on each red-spike collision. Collect green Strength fuel when it is safely reachable to stay alive longer.

Final Quick Start

If you only remember five things, remember these:

1. Space / Tap → Jump
2. Avoid red spikes
3. Yellow square → Gravity changes
4. Green circle → +1 Strength
5. P → Pause



Survive longer, react faster,
and score higher!

SPIKE **RUNNER**

Jump → Avoid → Collect → Shift → Survive

